UX DESIGN CASE STUDY

Two parishes. One website. Donations online.

Built around the people who use it.

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January – May 2011 · Archdiocese of Boston

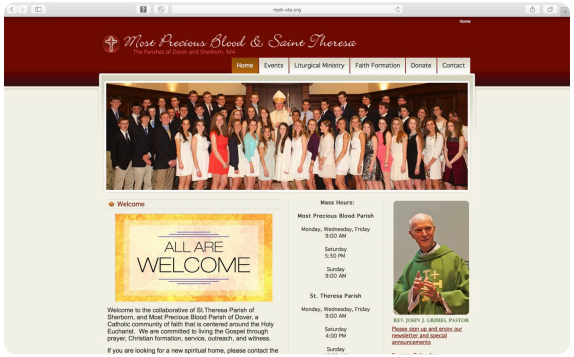
THE BUSINESS PROBLEM

Two parishes, working together. A website that didn't show it.

The Church of the Most Precious Blood and Saint Theresa of Lisieux Parish work in partnership. Their website did not show it.

Visitors could not find service times. Donations could not be made online. The site looked dated — on every device.

For a parish, that is not a design problem. It is lost donors.



The parish homepage before the redesign

WHAT SHE DID

Research first. Design second. Test everything.

01

Research

Interviews and empathy maps with the people who use the site.

02

Design

A new sitemap, wireframes, and prototypes — low- and high-fidelity.

03

Test

A usability study: five participants, testing on their own devices.

04

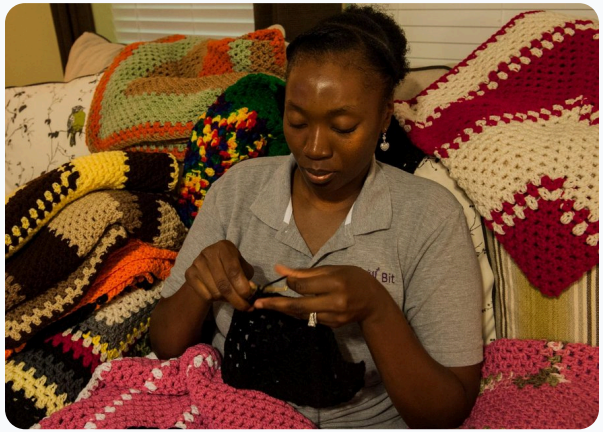
Iterate

Revisions from what testing found — simpler giving, clearer layout.

Built on Joomla, so the parishes update it themselves. Fully responsive, meeting Archdiocese standards. Delivered January to May 2011, on schedule.

THE USER

Eleanor, 62. She just wants to find what she needs.



“I just want to find what I need quickly.”

Eleanor Vance, 62 — retired North Andover teacher, widow, active in her parish.

Her goal: find parish information — services, contacts, events — and donate online.

Her frustrations: difficult navigation, outdated content, poor mobile.

Persona based on user research for this capstone

WHAT SHE FOUND

Three problems. Three business risks.

1

Navigation

Confusing menus, poor search, broken links.

So what: missed connections.

2

Donations

Giving leaves the site for a third-party page.

So what: donors give up.

3

Mobile

Layout breaks on tablets and phones.

So what: visitors locked out.

HER JOURNEY

Five steps to donate. Four points of friction.

STEP	WHAT SHE DOES	FEELING	WHAT CHANGES
1 · Search	Searches for the parish.	**Hopeful**	Easy to find.
2 · Homepage	Scans for times.	**Frustrated**	Times shown clearly.
3 · Service times	Clicks “Worship,” scrolls.	**Annoyed**	Times on homepage.
4 · Donate	Clicks “Donate,” redirected.	**Overwhelmed**	Giving on-site.
5 · Contact	Finds an email, no phone.	**Resigned**	Phone, email, form.

Keep her hopeful all the way to the donation.

THE SOLUTION

Structure first: one site, easy to find everything.

Main navigation

Home

About Us
Our History · Our Staff · Our Beliefs

Visit Us
Service Times · Location · What to Expect

Connect
Events Calendar · News & Updates · Contact Us

Give Online
Donations · Other Ways to Give

Footer

Privacy Policy · Terms of Service

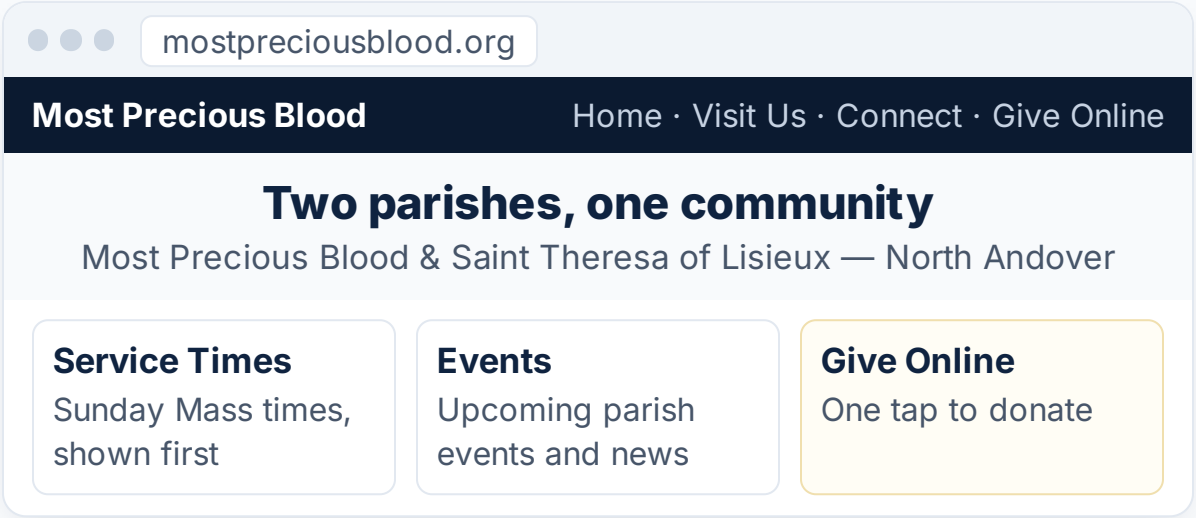
Contact Information
Address, phone number, email

Social Media Links

Design intent: service times, contact, and giving — one tap from anywhere.

THE SOLUTION

The new homepage: what matters, first.



Homepage wireframe — service times first, giving one tap away.

THE SOLUTION

Giving, simplified.

1 Home → 2 Visit Us → 3 Events → 4 Give Online → 5 Confirm

Five steps from finding information to donating online.

BEFORE

- ✕ Redirected to a third-party site
- ✕ Multi-step, unclear instructions
- ✕ Same information entered twice

AFTER

- ✓ Integrated into the parish site
- ✓ Simplified steps, clear instructions
- ✓ One checkbox reuses the information

THE EVIDENCE

Tested with real users before it shipped.

Five participants. Three problems found — all three fixed.

1 **Navigation** — couldn't find service times. **Fixed:** clearer navigation.

2 **Donations** — confusing process. **Fixed:** shorter, integrated giving.

3 **Mobile** — layout issues on small screens. **Fixed:** layouts for every size.

Unmoderated, remote, United States · Five participants · 20–30 minutes each.

THE EVIDENCE

Before and after: the donation page.

BEFORE

- ✕ Redirected to a third-party site
- ✕ Multi-step, unclear instructions
- ✕ Same information entered twice

AFTER

- ✓ Integrated into the parish site
- ✓ Simplified steps, clear instructions
- ✓ One checkbox reuses the information

The same page, after testing.

ACCESSIBILITY

Built for the audience that actually uses it.

An older congregation is not an edge case. It is the audience.

A

Larger type

Large type, high contrast, adjustable size.

B

Keyboard access

Fully navigable by keyboard, with clear focus.

C

Screen reader

Semantic HTML, alt text, proper headings.

THE RESULT

A website that shows the partnership — and takes donations.

- **The partnership is visible on every page.**
  Two parishes, one community — stated at the top, not buried.
- **Donations happen online, in a few clear steps.**
  Integrated into the parish site — no third-party redirect, no retyping.
- **It works on every device.**
  Built on Joomla — the parishes update it themselves.

WHAT THIS PROVES

She manages stakeholders. She ships.

1 **Multiple stakeholders, one site.** Two parishes and an Archdiocese.

2 **External standards, no brief.** She created the structure herself.

3 **Tested before delivery.** Findings changed the design.

4 **On time.** January to May 2011, a complete redesign on schedule.

LET'S TALK

If your website is losing people — or losing donations — let's fix it.

The same approach applies to any organization: start with the people who use the site, test with real users, and ship a redesign that works for them.

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